MANEESH AGNIHOTRI



HOLY LAND
The Ram temple coming up in Ayodhya

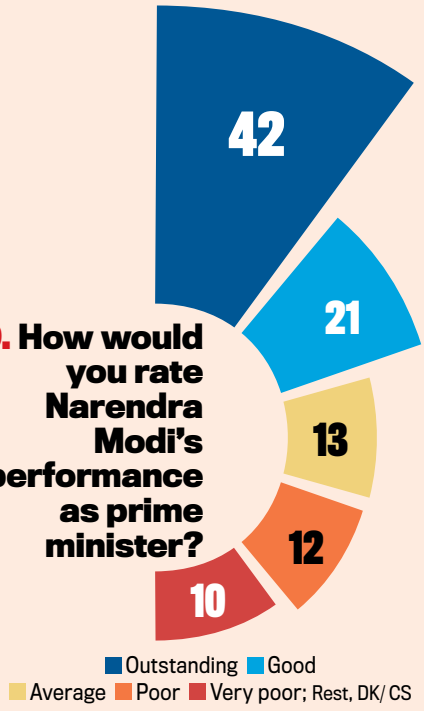
third consecutive win with a full majority. The BJP on its own is expected to win 287 seats—which, though lower than the emphatic 303-seat tally it won on its own in 2019—is still 15 more than the 272 needed for a simple majority in the 543-member Lok Sabha. The National Democratic Alliance (NDA), which the BJP heads, is projected to get 306 seats overall, 47 less than its tally of 353 seats in 2019. This diminution is a reflection of how the BJP's allies, despite recent attempts to bolster their numbers, have dwindled in strength, which should be a cause of concern for the party and the prime minister.

Significantly, these findings come at a time when the Opposition seems to have finally got its act together and formed an alliance cleverly called INDIA, or the Indian National Developmental Inclusive Alliance (INDIA), which includes members of the erstwhile United Progressive Alliance (UPA) headed by the Indian National Congress. This recast has proved to be beneficial, especially with the Janata Dal-United (JD-U) and the Shiv Sena (Uddhav Balasaheb Thackeray) joining its fold, with the MOTN predicting 193 seats for the INDIA combine, 102 more than the erstwhile UPA's tally in 2019. However, though the Congress will remain the single-largest Opposition party, the new alliance will boost the numbers of other parties more than for the Grand Old Party. Our survey shows a 22-seat gain for the Congress—from 52 to 74.

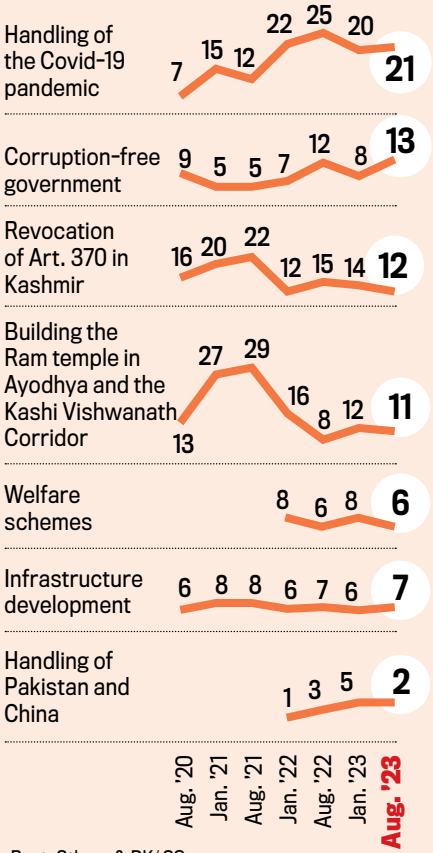
17%

THINK THAT OF ALL ISSUES, CONSTRUCTION OF THE RAM TEMPLE WILL BENEFIT THE BJP THE MOST IN 2024

Q. How would you rate Narendra Modi's performance as prime minister?



Q. What in your view is the single biggest achievement of the NDA government?



Rest: Others & DK/ CS

Its work during the pandemic still holds the government in good stead